

# SKULL

THERE ARE 29 BONES IN THE SKULL – 22 BONES FORM THE SKULL ITSELF, WITH 21 OF THEM, EXCLUDING THE LOWER JAW, FUSED TOGETHER. THE OTHER BONES ARE THE HYOID BONE IN THE NECK AND THREE PAIRS OF TINY EAR BONES, CALLED OSSICLES.



## SKULL SUTURES

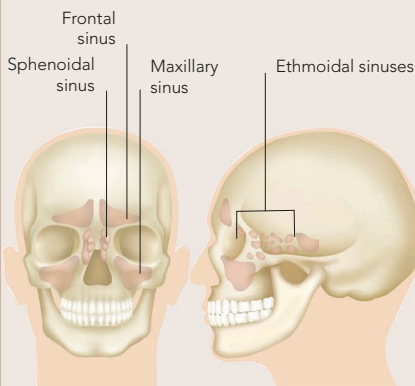
Lines on the skull's surface, highlighted here, are the fused margins of the skull bones.

## SKULL

Two groups of bones make up the skull. The upper set of eight bones forms the dome-like cranium (cranial skull or cranial vault), which encloses and protects the brain. The other 14 bones make the skeleton of the face. During growth in childhood, 21 of the 22 bones become strongly fused at faint joint lines, known as sutures. The lower jaw, or mandible, remains unfixed and is linked to the rest of the skull at the two jaw, or temporomandibular, joints.

## SINUSES

The four pairs of sinuses, known as paranasal sinuses, are air-filled cavities within the skull bones. They are named after the bones in which they are located: maxillary, frontal, sphenoidal, and ethmoidal sinuses. The first three pairs have fairly well-defined shapes. The ethmoidal sinuses are more honeycomb-like and variable.



## RESONANT WEIGHT-SAVERS

The sinuses help to lighten the skull's overall weight, and also act as resonating chambers to give each person's voice an individual character.

## SKULL AND HEAD REGIONS

Two sets of bones form the structure of the skull. The eight bones that enclose the brain are called the cranial vault.

